

PROJECT DOCUMENTATION REPORT

GAMEGUARD

A DIGITAL GAMING SELF-MANAGEMENT SOLUTION

Helping young people enjoy games without letting gaming take over.

Problem Focus: Excessive Gaming Among Young People

Technology Area: Mobile Application + Smart Screen-Time Management

Theme: Futuristic Gaming Technology

1. PROJECT OVERVIEW

GameGuard is a proposed mobile application designed to help young people manage gaming time before it affects schoolwork, sleep, physical activity, and relationships. The idea comes from the identified problem of excessive gaming, where a person may play for long periods, lose track of time, neglect responsibilities, sacrifice sleep, and become irritated when unable to play.

Instead of completely preventing gaming, the solution encourages balanced gaming. It uses scheduled playtime, reminders, break alerts, homework-first rules, sleep protection, and a simple progress dashboard. The goal is to make healthy gaming habits easier to follow through technology.

2. IDENTIFIED PROBLEM

The main problem identified in the infographic is excessive gaming among young people.

- Playing for long periods and having difficulty stopping.
- Losing track of time while playing.
- Neglecting schoolwork and other responsibilities.
- Reducing sleep because of late-night gaming.
- Becoming irritated or frustrated when unable to play.
- Spending less time on physical activity, family, friends, hobbies, and offline activities.

Excessive gaming can also affect concentration and academic performance. Long periods of screen use may contribute to eye strain, poor posture, and inactivity. When gaming becomes a main way of coping with stress, it may become harder for a young person to control the amount of time spent playing.

3. PROPOSED IT-ENABLED SOLUTION: GAMEGUARD

GameGuard is a student-friendly digital tool that combines a gaming schedule, screen-time monitoring, reminders, and personal goals in one application. The application does not treat gaming as completely bad. Instead, it helps users create limits and balance gaming with responsibilities.

FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	PURPOSE
Gaming Schedule	User chooses when and how long gaming is allowed.	Creates a clear limit and routine.
Smart Reminders	Alerts appear before the gaming period ends and when a break is needed.	Helps the user stop before losing track of time.
Homework-First Mode	Gaming can be unlocked after the user marks important school tasks as completed.	Encourages responsibilities before entertainment.
Sleep Guard	The app gives stronger reminders before the user's chosen bedtime.	Protects sleep from late-night gaming.
Break Timer	After continuous play, the app reminds the user to stand, move, rest the eyes, and drink water.	Reduces long uninterrupted screen use.
Balance Dashboard	Shows gaming time compared with study, sleep, exercise, and offline activities.	Makes habits easier to understand and improve.

4. PROJECT OBJECTIVES

- Help young people set realistic limits for gaming time.
- Reduce gaming that interferes with homework, sleep, and daily responsibilities.
- Encourage regular breaks and healthier screen habits.
- Promote offline activities such as exercise, hobbies, family time, and social interaction.
- Give users simple feedback about their gaming habits so they can make better decisions.

5. TARGET USERS

- Primary users: Young people and students who regularly play online or digital games.
- Secondary users: Parents, guardians, teachers, or school support personnel who may help young people build healthy technology habits.

The interface should remain simple and non-judgmental because the purpose is behavior management rather than punishment. Users should feel that the application is helping them control their gaming, not taking gaming away from them.

6. PROPOSED USER FLOW

1. Create a profile and set the usual gaming schedule.
2. Set important goals such as homework completion, bedtime, and daily breaks.
3. Start a gaming session through the GameGuard timer.
4. Receive reminders as the session approaches its limit.
5. Take scheduled breaks during long gaming sessions.
6. Receive a stronger reminder when gaming approaches bedtime.
7. Review the daily or weekly balance dashboard.
8. Adjust the schedule when the user notices repeated problems.

7. SIMPLE SYSTEM DESIGN

INPUT

- Gaming schedule and preferred playtime
- Bedtime and study schedule
- User-set gaming limits
- Optional activity and break goals

PROCESS

- Track gaming session duration
- Compare current time with user limits
- Send reminders and break notifications
- Record completed goals and daily screen-time patterns

OUTPUT

- Gaming-time alerts
- Break and sleep reminders
- Daily/weekly balance report
- Progress toward healthier gaming habits

8. TECHNOLOGY REQUIREMENTS

TECHNOLOGY	PURPOSE
Mobile Application	Android or iOS interface for schedules, timers, reminders, and dashboard.
Screen-Time Data	Uses device screen-time or application-usage information where available and permitted.
Notification System	Sends time-limit, break, homework, and bedtime reminders.
Cloud Database	Stores user preferences and progress securely if an account-based version is developed.
Dashboard	Converts usage data into simple charts or indicators that are easy for students to understand.

9. EXPECTED BENEFITS

- Better control over gaming time.
- More consistent completion of school responsibilities.
- Improved awareness of sleep and break needs.
- More opportunities for exercise, hobbies, family time, and offline social activities.
- A clearer understanding of personal gaming patterns.
- A practical technology-based approach that supports self-discipline instead of simply banning games.

10. POSSIBLE CHALLENGES AND LIMITATIONS

- Users may ignore or disable reminders.
- Screen-time tracking may differ depending on the device and operating system.
- The application cannot replace guidance from parents, teachers, or health professionals when gaming behavior becomes severe.
- Users may find strict limits frustrating, so the system should allow reasonable customization.
- Privacy and data security must be considered if the application stores usage information.

11. IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

PHASE	ACTIVITY
Phase 1 – Planning	Finalize target users, requirements, screen designs, and rules for healthy gaming.
Phase 2 – Design	Create the futuristic gaming-themed interface, user flow, dashboard, and notification system.
Phase 3 – Development	Build the schedule, timer, reminders, goals, and usage dashboard.
Phase 4 – Testing	Test the application with students and check whether the

	features are understandable and useful.
Phase 5 – Improvement	Use feedback to adjust reminders, limits, interface design, and accessibility.
Phase 6 – Launch	Release the application for controlled use and monitor its effectiveness.

12. EVALUATION OF THE PROPOSED SOLUTION

The project can be evaluated using simple indicators before and after a trial period:

- Average daily gaming time.
- Number of gaming sessions that exceed the user's chosen limit.
- Percentage of school tasks completed before gaming.
- Frequency of late-night gaming.
- Number of breaks taken during long sessions.
- User feedback on whether the application helped them control gaming time.

A successful result would not necessarily mean that gaming disappears. Instead, success would mean that users become more aware of their gaming habits and are better able to balance gaming with school, sleep, physical activity, and offline life.

13. CONCLUSION

Excessive gaming can become a problem when it takes time away from schoolwork, sleep, responsibilities, physical activity, and relationships. GameGuard proposes a practical IT-enabled solution by using features that young people already understand, such as timers, notifications, schedules, and progress dashboards.

The project focuses on balance rather than completely stopping gaming. By helping users set limits, take breaks, finish responsibilities first, and protect their sleep, the proposed system can support healthier gaming habits while still allowing games to remain a source of fun and recreation.

14. VISUAL AND INTERFACE THEME

The project documentation follows the same visual direction as the provided gaming infographic: a dark purple/plum background, neon purple headings, electric blue highlights, bright white text, and yellow accent elements. The overall style is futuristic, gaming-inspired, and energetic, while the report format remains suitable for academic project documentation.

15. References and Basis of the Project

- World Health Organization (WHO). (2020). Addictive behaviours: Gaming disorder. <https://www.who.int/news-room/questions-and-answers/item/addictive-behaviours-gaming-disorder>
- World Health Organization (WHO). (2018). Inclusion of “gaming disorder” in ICD-11. <https://www.who.int/news/item/14-09-2018-inclusion-of-gaming-disorder-in-icd-11>
- American Academy of Pediatrics. (2024). The Family Media Plan. Pediatrics, 154(6), e2024067417. <https://publications.aap.org/pediatrics/article/154/6/e2024067417/199968/The-Family-Media-Plan>
- American Academy of Pediatrics. (2016). Media Use in School-Aged Children and Adolescents. Pediatrics, 138(5), e20162592. <https://publications.aap.org/pediatrics/article/138/5/e20162592/60321/Media-Use-in-School-Aged-Children-and-Adolescents>
- American Academy of Pediatrics. (2025). Screen Time Guidelines. <https://www.aap.org/en/patient-care/media-and-children/center-of-excellence-on-social-media-and-youth-mental-health/qa-portal/qa-portal-library/qa-portal-library-questions/screen-time-guidelines/>